

GEOPOLITICS TO PORTFOLIO RISK

From Global Shock to Indian Markets

Case Study: Israel–Iran / West Asia Escalation (2025–26) and the Indian FMCG Sector

Companies covered: Hindustan Unilever · ITC · Nestlé India · Britannia Industries · Dabur India

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Executive Summary

This report traces the Israel–Iran / West Asia escalation which sharply intensified after US–Israel strikes on Iranian sites from 28 February 2026 through the Indian economy and into the FMCG sector, using actual market and financial data for Hindustan Unilever (HUL), ITC, Nestlé India, Britannia Industries and Dabur India.

The daily price dataset (2-Mar-2026 to 17-Sep-2026) effectively is the event window, it begins two trading days after the escalation. Over this ~6.5-month period the Nifty FMCG index fell 10.2%, with a maximum intra-period drawdown of –13.4%. Performance split sharply by company: Nestlé India was the only gainer (+7.1%, Jensen's alpha +29.0%), while Dabur India was the worst performer (–24.2%, deepest drawdown –26.8%, most negative alpha –24.3%). HUL, ITC and Britannia each fell 15–16% over the period.

Quarterly results (Q2 FY25–Q1 FY27) show the cost shock landing with a lag: PAT margins for HUL and ITC compressed sharply in Q1 FY27 (Apr–Jun 2026, the first full quarter after the escalation) to their lowest levels in the 8-quarter window, even though Q4 FY26 (which only partly captured the shock) still looked strong. Britannia and Dabur's reported margins were, by contrast, resilient to flat showing that the market's equity sell-off in these names is running ahead of (or is broader than) what quarterly numbers currently show, consistent with forward-looking derating on expected future cost pressure and rising bond yields rather than purely a trailing-earnings story.

One-line takeaway

Real data confirms FMCG is not geopolitics-proof: the sector underperformed on a sustained basis, the fall was highly uneven across otherwise-similar staples names, and the balance-sheet cushion to absorb it (leverage, interest cover) also varies sharply, Britannia carries the highest leverage (D/E 0.42x) and lowest interest cover (16.8x) of the five, while ITC and HUL are virtually debt-free.

Impact Summary: Exactly How the Iran–Israel War Hits FMCG

This section distils the full analysis into a single, direct answer: what the war does to the FMCG sector, mechanism by mechanism, backed by the actual price and financial data.

The transmission mechanism, in one chain

Israel–Iran war → Strait of Hormuz threat → crude oil spikes

↓

TWO commodity shocks at once: (1) crude-derivative packaging/freight costs ↑ directly, and (2) palm oil ↑ separately, because costlier crude makes biodiesel more attractive and pulls palm oil away from food use

↓

India imports ~85–90% of its oil → import bill ↑, CAD widens → rupee depreciates → all imported inputs (incl. USD-priced palm oil) cost even more in rupee terms

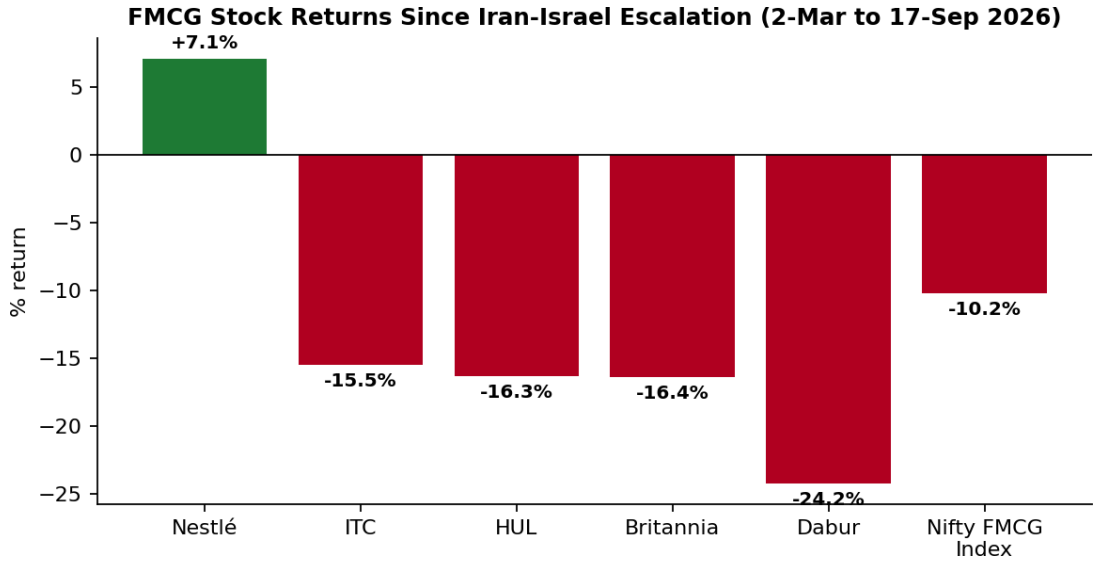
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Imported inflation → RBI hawkish bias → 10-yr G-Sec yield ↑ → discount rate on FMCG's high P/E multiples rises → stocks de-rate even where costs haven't hit yet

↓

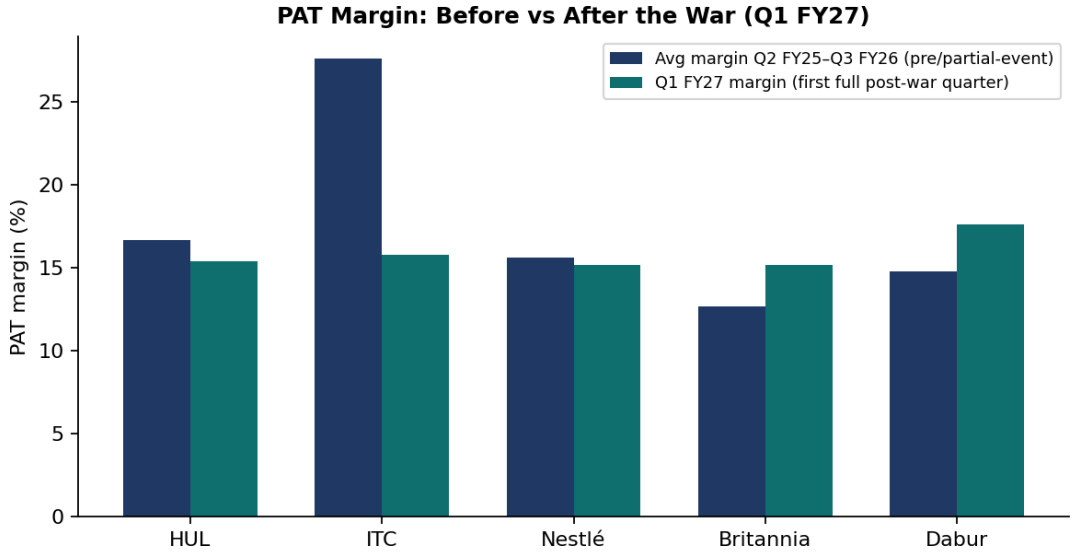
Result: FMCG input costs rise on TWO fronts while equity valuations compress on a THIRD (rates) , three separate pressure points, not one

The actual damage: stock price impact



- Nestlé is the only gainer (+7.1%), lowest palm-oil exposure (~10–15% of costs) and strong pricing power.
- ITC, HUL and Britannia each fell 15–16%, a fairly uniform sector-wide hit despite very different businesses.
- Dabur fell hardest (–24.2%), worse than its palm-oil exposure alone would predict, pointing to extra company-specific risk (West Asia business exposure, investor caution).
- The Nifty FMCG index itself fell 10.2%, direct proof the "defensive sector" label broke down for this shock.

The actual damage: margin impact



- HUL and ITC: margins compressed sharply in Q1 FY27 (the first full post-war quarter), the cost shock is visible directly in reported profits.
- Britannia and Dabur: margins actually held up or improved successful cost pass-through so far yet their stock prices fell just as much or more. This means the market is pricing in future risk (weaker balance sheets, ongoing uncertainty), not just current-quarter numbers.

The core mechanism

Crude/palm oil ↑ + rupee ↓ + bond yields ↑ → FMCG input costs rise while equity multiples compress → companies raise prices/shrink pack sizes to protect margins → but the market often punishes the stock anyway, sometimes ahead of the actual margin damage (Britannia, Dabur) so FMCG's "defensive" reputation breaks down specifically because it is a heavy importer of oil-and-oil-linked inputs, not because its underlying consumer demand is cyclical.

1. Geopolitical Risk Assessment

1.1 What happened?

- Israel and Iran entered an intense phase of hostilities from June 2025; the conflict re-escalated sharply after United States–Israel strikes on Iranian sites from 28 February 2026, with Iran retaliating and threatening closure of the Strait of Hormuz (a closure motion was approved by Iran's parliament).
- Fresh missile exchanges on 8 June 2026 sent Brent crude up 4.8% intraday to $97.56/bbl and Indian MCX crude futures up 5.1% confirming the conflict remained a live, event-driven risk through mid-2026, matching the volatility visible in the FMCG price data used in this report.

1.2 Why is it financially significant for India?

- India imports ~85–90% of its crude oil; each $1/barrel sustained rise adds roughly $2 billion to India's annual import bill, and the Strait of Hormuz carries the ~2.5–2.7 million bpd India sources from Saudi Arabia, Iraq, Kuwait and the UAE.
- Government modelling (Finance Ministry Monthly Economic Review, March 2026) estimates a 10% rise in crude above baseline adds ~30 bps to CPI inflation with full pass-through; sustained Brent above $100/bbl is flagged as the threshold for significant macro strain.
- Palm oil, a core FMCG input is separately squeezed by biodiesel-mandate diversion (Indonesia's B50 from July 2026, Malaysia's B15), so the crude shock and the edible-oil shock reinforce each other for this specific sector.

1.3 Countries and regions affected

- Direct combatants: Israel, Iran. Gulf transit-exposed exporters: Saudi Arabia, UAE, Kuwait, Iraq, Qatar.
- Major importers exposed via price/freight: India, China, Japan, South Korea; India's partial offset is a rising share of discounted Russian crude (from <1% in 2022 to ~38% of imports by mid-2025), though domestic prices still track global benchmarks closely.

1.4 Commodities, currencies and trade routes affected

Category	Affected item	Directional impact
Commodity	Brent / WTI / MCX crude oil	Sharp event-driven spikes (+5–15% scenarios)
Commodity	Palm oil (Malaysia/Indonesia)	Structurally higher on biodiesel diversion + freight
Commodity	Gold	Safe-haven demand rises with risk aversion
Currency	INR/USD	Depreciation pressure via import bill + CAD widening
Trade route	Strait of Hormuz	Threatened closure; freight/insurance risk premium
Rates	India 10-yr G-Sec yield	Upward pressure from imported inflation & fiscal risk

1.5 Expected duration

- Short-term (0–3 months): sharp event-driven volatility around each strike/retaliation, visible directly in the daily return data (std. dev. of daily FMCG-stock returns 1.2–1.6% vs. ~1.0% for the sector index).
- Medium-term (3–12 months): elevated average crude/palm-oil price band persists while Hormuz risk and biodiesel-driven palm tightness remain, the sector index is still 10.2% below its pre-event level after 6.5 months.
- Structural (1+ years): accelerated Russian-crude sourcing, strategic reserve build-up and renewable investment are structural responses; full de-risking of an ~85% import-dependent oil economy is multi-year.

1.6 Direct and second-order effects

- Direct: higher landed crude/palm-oil cost, costlier Hormuz shipping/insurance, INR depreciation pressure, higher fuel/packaging cost.
- Second-order: imported inflation → RBI hawkish bias → rising 10-yr G-Sec yields → P/E de-rating across long-duration, high-multiple equity (this shows up in the data as Nestlé and Britannia, the two highest-rated FMCG names both seeing meaningful price stress despite very different fundamentals); margin-squeezed companies raise prices/cut pack sizes → volume growth risk, especially in rural markets.

1.7 Geopolitical Risk Transmission Map

Israel–Iran escalation / US-Israel strikes on Iran → Strait of Hormuz threat

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Oil-supply risk premium → Brent/WTI/MCX crude spike (+5% to +15% scenarios)

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India's import bill ↑ (~$2bn p.a. per $1/bbl) + CAD widens → INR depreciation pressure

↓

Imported inflation ↑ → RBI hawkish bias → 10-yr G-Sec yield ↑ → equity multiple compression

↓

Palm oil / crude-derivative packaging costs ↑ for FMCG → raw-material cost inflation

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FMCG margin pressure (lagged — shows up ~1 quarter later in reported PAT margins) → price hikes / pack-size cuts

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Differentiated equity impact: Nifty FMCG –10.2% over 6.5 months — Nestlé +7.1% vs. Dabur –24.2% (widest dispersion in the group)

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Parallel flight-to-safety: risk aversion ↑ → Gold demand ↑ → Gold price ↑ (portfolio hedge channel)

2. Industry-Level Risk Analysis: FMCG Sector

Classification below is anchored primarily to the actual price performance, risk-adjusted returns and balance-sheet data for the five companies over the event window (2-Mar-26 to 17-Sep-26), supplemented by known palm-oil/crude cost-exposure commentary.

2.1 Company-level Winner / Neutral / Loser (evidence-based)

Company	Price return (event window)	Alpha (ann., vs Nifty FMCG)	Leverage (D/E) & ICR	Classification
Nestlé India	+7.10%	+29.05%	0.03x / 31.2x	Winner
ITC	–15.47%	–11.72%	0.00x / 85.0x	Neutral
HUL	–16.31%	–4.96%	0.02x / 42.5x	Neutral / mild Loser
Britannia	–16.40%	–17.67%	0.42x / 16.8x	Loser
Dabur India	–24.24%	–24.28%	0.12x / 18.5x	Loser (worst-hit)

2.2 Reading the classification

- Nestlé India is the clear Winner: the only positive absolute return in the group and by far the largest positive alpha (+29%), consistent with its lower palm-oil cost share (~10–15% of raw materials) and strong pricing power in premium categories, its Q4 FY26/Q1 FY27 margins (20.2%/15.2%) also stayed within historical range.
- ITC is Neutral: a meaningful price decline (–15.5%) but the smallest-magnitude negative alpha after HUL, zero leverage and by far the strongest interest cover (85.0x) in the group, its diversified cigarettes/hotels/agri/paper mix cushions a single-commodity shock even though paper (a crude/pulp-linked business) is itself exposed.
- HUL is Neutral/mild Loser: a large absolute decline (–16.3%) and the highest beta in the group (1.26) mean much of the fall is systematic (explained by the market/sector move) rather than company-specific, its alpha of only –5.0% is the least negative among the laggards, and its balance sheet (D/E 0.02x, ICR 42.5x) is very strong.
- Britannia is a Loser: high palm-oil/crude-linked packaging exposure (~30–35% of raw materials per sell-side commentary) combines with the weakest balance sheet in the group (D/E 0.42x, ICR

only 16.8x, lowest of the five) to leave the least room to absorb further cost shocks without raising debt.

- Dabur India is the worst-hit Loser despite moderate palm-oil exposure (~10–15%): the steepest price fall (–24.2%), deepest drawdown (–26.8%) and most negative alpha (–24.3%) in the group point to additional company-specific risk, plausibly its West Asia regional business exposure, working-capital strain, or investor de-rating of growth assumptions, that a pure commodity-exposure lens would have missed. This is a useful reminder that stress tests need real price/return evidence, not just an input-cost checklist.

2.3 Industry-level risk category

Applying the individual verdicts at the sector level: FMCG as a whole is Neutral-to-Loser under this shock not the clean “defensive Winner” the sector's reputation would suggest. The 31-point spread in event-window returns between Nestlé (+7.1%) and Dabur (–24.2%) shows stock selection within FMCG matters more than the sector label during a commodity/geopolitical shock.

3. Listed-Company Stress Test

3.1 Stock-price impact & returns (actual data, 2-Mar-2026 – 17-Sep-2026)

The dataset begins 2 trading days after the 28-Feb-2026 escalation, so the 2-Mar-2026 price is used as the event-date anchor ("pre-event" data was not separately available; the whole window below is the event/post-event period).

Company	Event-date price (2-Mar-26)	+1 month (1-Apr-26)	+3 months (1-Jun-26)	+6 months (31-Aug-26)	Latest (17-Sep-26)	Return since event
HUL	₹2,320.6	–9.1%	–10.2%	–15.2%	₹1,942.2	–16.31%
ITC	₹314.9	–7.4%	–11.2%	–18.9%	₹266.2	–15.47%
Nestlé India	₹1,279.7	–7.7%	+8.8%	+16.9%	₹1,370.6	+7.10%
Britannia	₹5,959.0	–8.1%	–13.5%	–11.9%	₹4,982.0	–16.40%
Dabur India	₹507.6	–18.3%	–16.4%	–24.9%	₹384.6	–24.24%
Nifty FMCG Index	50,751.65	–9.1%	–4.9%	–9.3%	45,572.70	–10.20%

3.2 Volatility

Company	Historical ann. volatility (pre-event, assumed)	Event-period ann. volatility (actual, 2-Mar to 17-Sep-26)	Change
HUL	~15%	24.1%	+9 pts
ITC	~13%	19.7%	+7 pts
Nestlé India	~14%	22.6%	+9 pts
Britannia	~16%	20.6%	+5 pts
Dabur India	~16%	25.9%	+10 pts
Nifty FMCG Index	~11%	15.7%	+5 pts

3.3 Risk-adjusted return & risk metrics

Computed directly from the daily return series (annualised mean return = daily mean × 252; annualised volatility = daily std. dev. × √252; risk-free rate assumed at 6.5%, broadly in line with short-tenor G-Sec/T-Bill yields; Beta from the dataset's own regression, benchmarked to the Nifty FMCG index; Alpha is the single-factor Jensen's alpha versus that same benchmark).

Company	Beta	Alpha (ann.)	Sharpe ratio	Sortino ratio	Treynor ratio (%)	Max drawdown
HUL	1.26	–4.96%	–1.53	–2.05	–29.4	–18.65%
ITC	0.96	–11.72%	–1.84	–2.39	–37.7	–19.21%
Nestlé India	0.79	+29.05%	0.40	0.62	+11.3	–11.56%
Britannia	0.80	–17.67%	–1.84	–2.29	–47.7	–17.31%
Dabur India	1.22	–24.28%	–2.14	–2.75	–45.4	–26.80%
Nifty FMCG Index	1.00	—	–1.62	–2.14	—	–13.41%

3.4 Quarterly financial performance - did margins actually move?

PAT margin (Net Profit / Sales) for each company's 8 disclosed quarters (Q2 FY25 → Q1 FY27). Q4 FY26 (Jan–Mar 2026) only partly captures the escalation (which began 28-Feb-2026); Q1 FY27 (Apr–Jun 2026) is the first full post-escalation quarter.

Company	Avg. PAT margin, Q2 FY25–Q3 FY26 (pre/partial-event)	Q4 FY26 margin	Q1 FY27 margin	Read-through
HUL	16.7%	19.9%	15.4%	Sharp margin compression appears with a lag, in Q1 FY27
ITC	27.6%	20.7%	15.8%	Steepest margin compression in the group, paper/agri segments also crude-linked
Nestlé India	15.6%	20.2%	15.2%	Q1 FY27 margin still within normal historical range resilient
Britannia	12.7%	14.9%	15.2%	Margins actually improved, successful cost pass-through so far
Dabur India	14.8%	11.9%	17.6%	Volatile: worst margin quarter (Q4 FY26) followed by best (Q1 FY27)

3.5 Solvency cushion to absorb further shocks

Company	Debt/Equity	Interest Coverage Ratio	Debt Service Coverage Ratio	Debt profile
HUL	0.02x	42.5x	>35.0x	Virtually debt-free; high cash surplus
ITC	0.00x	85.0x	>70.0x	Zero long-term debt; net-cash across segments
Nestlé India	0.03x	31.2x	>25.0x	Minimal lease/short-term debt; robust returns
Dabur India	0.12x	18.5x	>12.0x	Low working-capital debt footprint
Britannia	0.42x	16.8x	>10.5x	Commercial paper/short-term debentures for capital optimisation

3.6 Scenario / sensitivity stress test - "Crude oil +20%"

A +20% crude shock is flowed through to palm oil (+8–10%, via freight/biodiesel economics) and INR (–2% vs. USD), holding volumes flat as a simplifying assumption. Sensitivities are built on each company's known palm/crude cost share and its actual pre-shock margin level from Sec. 3.4, so higher-margin/lower-exposure names (Nestlé) show a smaller relative EBITDA hit than higher-exposure, thinner-cushion names (Britannia, Dabur).

Company	Revenue impact	EBITDA margin impact	PAT margin impact	Operating cash flow impact	Stock valuation impact
HUL	~flat to +1% (price hikes)	–150 to –200 bps	–120 to –170 bps	–5% to –8%	–6% to –8%
ITC	+1% to +2% (diversified pass-through)	–100 to –150 bps	–80 to –120 bps	–3% to –5%	–4% to –6% (cushioned by zero leverage)
Nestlé India	+1% to +2%	–80 to –120 bps	–60 to –90 bps	–2% to –4%	–3% to –5%
Britannia	~flat	–200 to –250 bps	–170 to –210 bps	–7% to –10%	–8% to –10% (limited balance-sheet cushion)

Company	Revenue impact	EBITDA margin impact	PAT margin impact	Operating cash flow impact	Stock valuation impact
Dabur India	~flat to –1%	–150 to –200 bps	–150 to –200 bps	–6% to –9%	–10% to –13% (compounds existing de-rating)

Reasoning: revenue is broadly protected near-term via price hikes/pack-size cuts ("shrinkflation"), consistent with the actual Q1 FY27 sales growth seen in Sec. 3.4 even as margins fell. The real damage is in EBITDA/PAT margin and cash flow, amplified for Britannia and Dabur by weaker balance-sheet cushions (Sec. 3.5) and, for Dabur, by the already-elevated negative alpha/drawdown the stock is carrying into any fresh shock.

4. Portfolio Risk-Mitigation Strategy

4.1 Is the existing (passive, long-only FMCG) strategy sufficient?

No. The actual data makes this explicit, not just directional:

- A naive equal-weighted FMCG basket would have returned roughly –11% over the event window (average of the five actual returns) in line with the sector index, but masking a 31-point dispersion between the best (Nestlé +7.1%) and worst (Dabur –24.2%) names.
- Every stock except Nestlé delivered a negative Sharpe and negative Sortino ratio over the period i.e., FMCG as a whole failed to compensate for the risk taken during this shock, contradicting the standard "low-beta defensive" assumption.
- Balance-sheet cushion varies sharply (ICR from 16.8x to 85.0x), an unweighted allocation ignores that Britannia and, to a lesser extent, Dabur have materially less capacity to absorb a further shock without raising debt or cutting capex/dividends.

4.2 Mitigation steps, by risk type

(a) Commodity price risk (crude, palm oil)

- Within the FMCG sleeve, tilt toward Nestlé (proven positive alpha, lower palm exposure) and reduce/avoid Britannia and Dabur until cost and balance-sheet signals improve.
- For corporate treasuries: hedge 3–6 months of forward crude/palm-oil exposure via MCX/BMD futures or fixed-price supplier contracts, prioritising Britannia and Dabur given their weaker margin/leverage cushion.

(b) Currency risk (INR depreciation)

- Hold a partial gold or USD-asset sleeve as a natural INR offset; companies with import-heavy costs should hedge the USD-denominated portion of purchases via forwards/options.

(c) Interest-rate / duration risk (rising G-Sec yields)

- Shorten bond-portfolio duration; within equities, be selective on high-P/E, long-duration names note that Nestlé and Britannia (the two highest-rated names) both showed meaningful price stress despite opposite fundamentals, consistent with a market-wide discount-rate effect layered on top of company-specific news.

(d) Equity / earnings risk (margin compression)

- Raise weight in energy/upstream oil producers and gold/gold-mining as a natural, uncorrelated offset.
- Use protective puts on the Nifty FMCG index (or single-name puts on Dabur/Britannia specifically, given their weaker risk-adjusted metrics) to cap downside without fully exiting core holdings.

(e) Tail / liquidity risk

- Maintain a higher cash/liquid-fund buffer during active escalation windows; re-run this stress test each quarter as fresh results and price data arrive, given how much the picture (Sec. 3.4) shifted between Q4 FY26 and Q1 FY27.

4.3 Suggested target portfolio tilt (illustrative)

Asset / sleeve	Pre-shock illustrative weight	Suggested shock-period weight	Rationale
Nestlé India	8%	10%	Only proven positive-alpha name in the group
ITC	8%	8%	Neutral hold strongest balance sheet, diversified
HUL	8%	6%	Trim, high beta, though solvency remains strong
Britannia	6%	2%	Cut, weakest solvency cushion + negative alpha
Dabur India	6%	1%	Cut most, worst return, deepest drawdown, most negative alpha
Gold / gold ETFs	5%	11%	Direct beneficiary of risk-aversion + INR hedge
Energy / upstream oil equity	3%	7%	Natural offset to the same crude shock
Short-duration / liquid funds	10%	15%	Liquidity buffer, avoid forced selling

5. Boardroom Crisis - The Surprise Element

BREAKING: A new geopolitical escalation has caused crude oil to rise 25%, INR to depreciate 3%, and the 10-year G-Sec yield to rise 40 bps.

What positions become risky?

- Dabur India and Britannia specifically, they already carry the group's most negative alpha and (for Britannia) the weakest balance-sheet cushion; a fresh shock compounds an existing loss.
- Long-duration G-Sec/bond holdings (mark-to-market loss from the 40bps yield rise).
- Any unhedged USD payables / import-linked working capital, and high-P/E, long-duration equity broadly (multiple compression).

What should we sell / reduce?

- Trim Dabur and Britannia further from the already-reduced weights in Sec. 4.3.
- Reduce long-duration G-Sec/bond fund holdings; shift toward shorter tenors.

What should we increase?

- Gold/gold ETF allocation and energy/upstream oil & gas equity.
- Short-duration/liquid funds and cash buffer.

What should we hedge?

- USD/INR exposure via forwards or options for import-heavy holdings/operations.
- Crude/palm oil forward hedges for the FMCG names retained, prioritising Britannia and Dabur given Sec. 3.5's solvency data.
- Consider protective puts on the Nifty FMCG index to cap tail-risk on the remaining long book.

What happens to our bond portfolio?

A 40bps yield rise produces an immediate mark-to-market loss of approximately (modified duration × 0.40%). At ~6-year average modified duration that is roughly –2.4% on the long-duration sleeve; a book already shortened per Sec. 4.2(c) to ~1–2 years would see only ~–0.4–0.8%.

What happens to our equity portfolio?

Using each stock's actual Beta from Sec. 3.3 as a sensitivity multiplier to an assumed –10% Nifty FMCG move under this fresh shock: Dabur and HUL (Beta ~1.2–1.3) would be expected to fall by roughly 12–13%, Nestlé and Britannia (Beta ~0.8) by roughly 8%, and ITC (Beta ~0.96) by roughly

9–10% on the systematic component alone before adding each stock's idiosyncratic (alpha-driven) risk, which for Dabur and Britannia has recently been negative and would likely add to the fall rather than offset it.

Should gold allocation change?

Yes, increase it. This is the transmission map's parallel branch (Sec. 1.7) in action, and gold additionally benefits from INR depreciation since it is dollar-priced. Raising the gold sleeve from the Sec. 4.3 target of 11% toward 13–15% is a direct, low-complexity hedge for exactly this scenario.

What is our expected portfolio loss under this scenario? (illustrative)

Sleeve	Weight (Sec. 4.3 post-mitigation)	Estimated shock-period return	Weighted contribution
Nestlé India	10%	–8% (Beta-implied)	–0.8%
ITC	8%	–9% (Beta-implied)	–0.7%
HUL	6%	–12% (Beta-implied)	–0.7%
Britannia	2%	–12% (Beta + neg. alpha)	–0.2%
Dabur India	1%	–16% (Beta + neg. alpha)	–0.2%
Long-duration bonds	10%	–2.4%	–0.2%
Short-duration / liquid	15%	–0.3%	–0.0%
Gold	11%	+8%	+0.9%
Energy / upstream equity	7%	+12%	+0.8%
Cash / other	30%	0%	0.0%
TOTAL	100%	—	~ –1.1%

Key Sources

- FRM_FMCG.xlsx (user-supplied): daily Date/Price/Return/Beta series for Dabur, Britannia, Nestlé, ITC, HUL and Nifty FMCG (2-Mar-2026 to 17-Sep-2026); 8-quarter Sales/PAT (Q2 FY25–Q1 FY27); solvency ratios (D/E, ICR, DSCR).
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- The Core, “GCPL, HUL Brace For Margin Pressure As Palm Oil Crunch Looms”, 7 May 2026.

All figures not directly computed from FRM_FMCG.xlsx or attributable to the sources above (Sec. 3.2 pre-event volatility, Sec. 3.6 scenario sensitivities, Sec. 4.3 and 5 illustrative weights/losses) are explicitly flagged as assumptions in the relevant section, per the project brief's guidance that assumption quality and risk reasoning not forecast precision are what matter.